
This act summary is provided for the convenience of the public and members of the General Assembly. It is intended to provide a general summary of the act and may not be exhaustive. It has been prepared by the staff of the Office of Legislative Counsel without input from members of the General Assembly. It is not intended to aid in the interpretation of legislation or to serve as a source of legislative intent.

Act No. 131 (H.567). An act relating to unclaimed property, State retirement systems, and capital debt

Subjects: Property; unclaimed property; decedents' estates; Executive Branch; education; retirement; State Employees' Retirement System; State Teachers' Retirement System; Municipal Employees' Retirement System; postemployment benefits; capital debt

This act makes changes to the statutes governing unclaimed property, State retirement systems, and the Capital Debt Affordability Advisory Committee annual report.

Secs. 1–5 make amendments to the statutes governing unclaimed property. The act allows the State Treasurer to accept unclaimed property under a medical insurance policy and authorizes the Treasurer to require an explanation of benefits when unclaimed property is submitted to the Treasurer's office. The act increases the monetary thresholds in numerous instances to allow the Treasurer to issue expedited unclaimed property claims. Lastly, relating to unclaimed property, the act increases the threshold for unclaimed property that is greater than 10 years old that is withheld from the General Fund from \$100.00 to \$150.00. The act requires these monies to be transferred to the Vermont Retirement Security Fund up to a total annual maximum of \$300,000.00. The act provides the Treasurer with the sole discretion of transferring some of the monies to the Vermont Higher Education Endowment Trust Fund, still limited by the annual cap of \$300,000.00. On January 1, 2040, the statute is amended to deposit all unclaimed property that is at least 10 years old and valued at \$150.00 or more into the Vermont Higher Education Endowment Trust Fund up to an annual maximum of \$300,000.00.

Secs. 6–22 are related to the Vermont State Retirement Systems. Sec. 6 authorizes the assessment of penalties against any political subdivision of the State participating in the State Retirement System for payments due that are not received within 30 days after the installment due date set by the Retirement Board. Sec. 7 creates the Pension and Benefits Funding Task Force to review and report on the funding methodologies of the Vermont State Retirement System and the State Teachers' Retirement System, with a report due on or before December 15, 2026, regarding findings and recommendations for legislative action. Secs. 8–20 move the administrative and fiduciary oversight responsibilities for the State Employees' Postemployment Benefits Trust Fund and the Retired Teachers' Health and Medical Benefits Fund to the Vermont Pension Investment Commission. Secs. 21 and 22 authorize a member of the State Teachers' Retirement System or the Municipal Employees' Retirement System who is elected to serve as the president of an employee organization designated as the exclusive bargaining representative to receive creditable service for the period served as president provided that the employee organization deposits in the pension fund on behalf of the member the statutorily required amount.

Sec. 23 makes minor changes to the information required to be provided by the Capital Debt Affordability Advisory Committee in its annual report.

Multiple effective dates, beginning on June 15, 2026